

Nitrates: 2–4 times the EU limit?

A reported figure for the eastern main aquifer, tested against monitoring data

THE CLAIM

“...the highest concentrations of nitrate are observed in the eastern areas of the MSLA, ranging from 100 to 200 mg/L.”

Laudi et al., 2026, quoted by MaltaToday, 13 February 2026

MaltaToday adds: “two to four times higher than the EU safety limit of 50 mg/L”.

We could not read the paper's full text; the quotation is second-hand.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

The figures match; the eastern range is second-hand.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

2–4×

The arithmetic

100 and 200 mg/L are two and four times the 50 mg/L limit.

68.2%

Monitoring points at 50+

30 of 44 groundwater points averaged 50 mg/L or more, 2020–2023 (Commission review).

63.6%

Same share, 2016–2019

The share above the limit has risen.

75–200

mg/L, same team, 2025

Groundwater under potato and forage fields; the north-west regional aquifer was 25–100.

?

Tap water

Not tested: public supply is blended and treated.

FAIR TO SAY

Most monitoring points exceed 50 mg/L, so the headline picture holds. The exact eastern range needs the paper or EWA station data.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ EWA: station data for the eastern aquifer.

☐ Journal authors: the page for the quoted sentence.

☐ Readers: the study did not assess livestock.

☐ Readers: shallow wells are worst (83% over).